



ASPIRING MODELS queue up in sheer silhouette behind a curtain at the auditions for the upcoming Wills Lifestyle India Fashion Week Autumn/Winter 2010 in Delhi to walk the ramp for India's best designers.

LUCKNOW | Cleansing Act

After being lambasted for mindless spending over "dream projects" full of statues, Mayawati has decided to change her outlook on expense. The chief minister has already spent over Rs 2,600 crore on building memorials and parks and named them after Dalit icons, herself included. With two years left for the Assembly elections, she doesn't want to provide fresh ammunition for the Opposition. Now, as the chairperson of the State Rivers Authority, she has cleared Rs 2,426 crore for cleaning up the Ganga river. The task has been entrusted to Alok Ranjan, principal secretary, urban development. He says that the State Rivers Authority has submitted plans to the prime minister on the cleaning project and that work is expected to "commence shortly" at Kanpur, Allahabad and Varanasi stretches of the river. "The 400-km stretch from Kannauj to Varanasi is the most polluted, so the main focus will be there," says Ranjan.

by Subhash Mishra



ALLOCATING RS 2,426 CRORE FOR THE GANGA CLEAN-UP IS MAYAWATI'S WAY OF UNDOING THE BAD PUBLICITY SHE GOT FOR SPLURGING ON MEMORIALS.